

Fixtures, Wells and What Is Out of Scope

The fixture clearances, the water-quality questions, and the two places where the right answer is that you do not do it.

The numbers here

Toilet clearance — wall to wall	30 in
Toilet — center to the nearest wall	15 in
Shower stall — minimum dimension	22 in

Thirty across the whole space, fifteen from the center of the bowl to either side. The two numbers are the same rule stated twice — fifteen each way is thirty.

Water quality

YOU HAVE MISSED THIS 2 TIMES

Which statement about drinking water is FALSE?

That municipal water is more susceptible to contamination by harmful bacteria than water from a private well.

It is the other way round. Municipal supplies are treated, monitored and tested continuously. A private well is untreated groundwater with no one watching it, which is why a private well should be tested at least once a year.

YOU HAVE MISSED THIS

You can determine if well water is contaminated by:

Having it analyzed by a qualified agency.

You cannot tell by looking, smelling or tasting, and you are not equipped to test it. The answer is always to refer it to someone who can.

The limits of the inspection

YOU HAVE MISSED THIS

To test for water flow, an inspector will:

This is out of scope for a home inspector.

Measuring flow rate requires instruments and time that a home inspection does not include. You observe functional flow — whether fixtures run and drain — but you do not quantify it. When a plumbing question offers a measurement you would need equipment for, check whether the honest answer is that it falls outside the scope.

Say it back

Cover the page. Answer each one out loud.

1. Toilet clearance wall to wall, and center to wall?
2. Minimum shower stall dimension?
3. Which is more susceptible to bacterial contamination, municipal or well water?
4. How often should a private well be tested?
5. How do you determine whether well water is contaminated?
6. Does a home inspector test water flow?